THE SOLO FOUNDER'S

AI MARKETING PLAYBOOK

7 Strategies for Predictable Growth

A complete field guide to using AI tools for
Marketing your startup without a full team or a massive budget.

Inspired by frameworks from:
Traction by Gabriel Weinberg & Justin Mares
The 1-Page Marketing Plan by Allan Dib

How to Use This Guide

Welcome. You're a solo founder, which means you're doing the work of a five-person marketing team — alone, with limited time, limited budget, and unlimited pressure to grow.

This playbook was built specifically for you. Every strategy inside combines two battle-tested marketing frameworks — the Bullseye Method from Traction and the Before-During-After system from the 1-Page Marketing Plan — with modern AI tools that let you execute like a full team.

The guide is structured around 7 strategies. Each one maps to a phase of your marketing journey:

Phase	What You're Doing
BEFORE	Getting the right people to know you exist
DURING	Converting interested prospects into first-time buyers
AFTER	Turning customers into repeat buyers and referrers

You don't need to implement all 7 strategies at once. Start with Strategy 1 and Strategy 3, then layer in the rest as your capacity grows.

THE CORE RULE

Spend 50% of your time on product, 50% on getting traction. Most founders get this backwards. The marketing system you build here will prevent that mistake.

Why Solo Founders Struggle With Marketing

There is a dangerous assumption baked into most marketing advice: that you have a team. A content writer. A paid-ads specialist. An SEO person. A community manager.

You don't. And that's not a failure — it's a reality that requires a completely different playbook.

The Three Root Causes of Stalled Growth

1. Traction Channel Bias

In Traction, Gabriel Weinberg identifies 19 distinct traction channels — from content marketing and email to SEO, viral marketing, business development, and community building. Most founders explore only two or three, typically the ones they're already familiar with or that seem fashionable.

The uncomfortable truth: the traction channel that will work best for your business is often one you haven't seriously tested yet. AI changed this. For the first time, a solo founder can cheaply and quickly run parallel experiments across multiple channels.

2. Random Acts of Marketing

Allan Dib calls it "random acts of marketing" — sporadic blog posts, occasional social media activity, one email blast, a Google Ad that runs for two weeks. None of these build on each other. Without a system, you're hunting every day instead of farming.

This playbook gives you the farm — a structured marketing system where every action compounds.

3. Message-Market Mismatch

The most common reason marketing fails is not budget or strategy — it's that the message doesn't match the market's actual pain. Most founders write about what they built. Customers care about what problem gets solved for them.

AI tools now let you analyze your ideal customer language at scale, so your message can meet their mind exactly where it is.

THE SHIFT THIS PLAYBOOK ENABLES

You are going to stop being a founder who does some marketing, and become a marketer who runs a business. These 7 strategies are your operating system for that transformation.

S1

Strategy 1

AI-Powered Target Market Discovery

Know your customer better than they know themselves

Before you write a single word of marketing copy, before you choose a channel, before you spend one dollar on ads — you must be ruthlessly clear on who you are marketing to. This is the most leveraged activity in your entire marketing system.

As Allan Dib writes: "Trying to target everyone with your product or service is a terrible idea. In reality, this means no one." A 100-watt laser cuts through steel. A 100-watt light bulb just lights a room. Same energy. The difference is focus.

The PVP Index: Score Your Best Segment

The PVP Index (Personal Fulfillment, Value to Market, Profitability) helps you identify your highest potential niche. Score each customer segment you currently serve — or could serve — out of 10 across three dimensions:

Dimension	Question to Ask
Personal Fulfillment (P)	How much do you enjoy working with this type of customer? Would you do it for less money?
Value to Marketplace (V)	How much does this segment value your solution? Are they willing to pay a premium?
Profitability (P)	After time, support, and complexity, how profitable is this work really?

The segment with the highest combined score is your beachhead market. Dominate it before expanding. Once you own a niche, you can move to the next.

Build Your Customer Avatar with AI

An avatar is a vivid, specific portrait of one ideal customer — their job, fears, daily frustrations, vocabulary, and the conversation already going on in their head. Your entire marketing system is built to enter that conversation.

AI Prompt: Deep Customer Avatar

PROMPT TO USE IN CHATGPT OR CLAUDE

"I am building [product/service] for [target segment]. Create a detailed customer avatar including: demographics, job situation, top 3 daily frustrations, what they Googled last week related to this problem, the exact words they use when describing their pain to a friend, what they have already tried and why it failed, and what success looks like for them. Format as a detailed profile."

Run this prompt for each of your top 3 candidate segments. The output becomes your messaging foundation — the words the AI generates about their pain are the words you should use in your headlines.

Research Techniques AI Amplifies

- Reddit & Quora Analysis: Ask AI to summarize the top complaints in subreddits related to your space. These are unfiltered customer pain expressed in their own language.
- Review Mining: Paste Amazon reviews, G2 reviews, or Trustpilot reviews of competitors into AI and ask: 'What patterns of frustration and delight appear most frequently?'
- Keyword Intent Mapping: Use AI to analyze Google search queries in your space and categorize them by buyer intent (awareness, consideration, decision).
- Job-to-be-Done Analysis: Ask AI: 'What job is [customer type] trying to get done when they look for [your category]?' This reframes your pitch from features to outcomes.

THE NICHE PARADOX

The more narrowly you define your target market, the more expensive you seem — and the less price-sensitive your customers become. A heart specialist charges more than a GP. A wedding photographer charges more than a general portrait photographer. Specialization is pricing power.

Your Action Checklist: Strategy 1

1. Score all current/potential segments using the PVP Index. Choose one.
2. Build a detailed customer avatar using AI for your chosen segment.
3. Mine 20+ Reddit posts or competitor reviews with AI to extract pain language.
4. Write the single sentence that answers: 'My marketing is FOR [specific person] WHO struggles with [specific pain].'

S2

Strategy 2

Craft Your Irresistible Message & Offer

Stop describing your product. Start selling the result.

Most solo founder marketing sounds like a company brochure: name, logo, list of services, vague claim of quality. It talks about the founder and the product. It never enters the mind of the customer.

The goal of your message is not to inform. It is to trigger recognition: 'That's exactly my problem. This is for me.'

The Three-Part Message Architecture

Part 1: The Problem (Enter Their Mind)

Your message must lead with the problem your prospect is already experiencing — not the solution you have built. People buy pain relief more readily than they buy prevention. Lead with the ache.

> **AI PROMPT: PAIN ARTICULATION**
>
> "My customer is [avatar description]. Write 10 different opening sentences for a marketing message that capture the exact frustration they feel about [problem]. Use their vocabulary, not marketing jargon. Make each sentence feel like something they would say out loud to a colleague."

Part 2: The USP (Why You, Not Them)

Your Unique Selling Proposition answers the question: 'Why should I buy from you instead of your nearest competitor?' It is not about quality or service — those are baseline expectations. It is about a specific, demonstrable, and compelling difference.

The test: if you removed your logo and company name from your website, would a visitor know they're on your site — or could it be any competitor? If it could be anyone, your USP is not working.

> **AI PROMPT: USP GENERATOR**
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> "My business does [describe your service/product]. My target customer is [avatar]. My top three competitors are [names or types]. Analyze the gap between what competitors offer and what the customer actually wants. Generate 5 potential USP statements that are specific, credible, and outcome-focused — not vague quality claims."

Part 3: The Irresistible Offer

An offer is not a product. An offer is everything the customer gets, how risk is reversed for them, and why acting now makes sense. A strong offer stacks value, includes a specific guarantee, and creates urgency with a genuine reason why.

Offer Element	What It Does For the Customer

Core Promise	Clearly states the transformation or outcome they will get
Value Stacking	Bundles bonuses that feel more valuable than the price
Outrageous Guarantee	Reverses all the risk onto you, removing their fear
Scarcity / Urgency	Gives a real reason to act now rather than 'think about it'
Payment Plan	Makes high-ticket items feel affordable month-to-month

Writing Copy With AI: The Right Approach

AI can generate first drafts of headlines, email subjects, landing page copy, and ad copy at speed. But AI-generated copy needs your voice, your data, and your specific customer language layered in. Use it as a power draft, not a final product.

- Write 20 headline variations for your core offer using the format: '[Specific result] for [specific person] without [common fear]'
- Generate three versions of your elevator pitch using the formula: 'You know how [problem]? Well, what I do is [solution]. In fact, [proof].'
- Create A/B test pairs for landing page headlines — one leading with fear of loss, one with desire for gain
- Ask AI to critique your existing copy: 'Is this copy focused on me or on my customer? Rewrite it to be entirely customer-focused.'

Your Action Checklist: Strategy 2

1. Write a one-sentence pain statement that opens every piece of marketing you create.
2. Develop and test three USP statements — pick the one that generates the strongest reaction.
3. Build your full offer: core promise + guarantee + value stack.
4. Use AI to generate 20 headline variations and test the top 3 with your audience.

S3

Strategy 3

Run the AI-Augmented Bullseye Test

Find your single best traction channel faster than ever before

In Traction, Weinberg and Mares document 19 distinct traction channels through which businesses acquire customers. The insight that changed how I think about early-stage growth: the traction channel that will work best for your business is often one you have never seriously tested.

The Bullseye Framework gives you a systematic way to find it. AI dramatically compresses the time it takes.

The 19 Traction Channels

Channel	What It Is
Targeting Blogs	Getting niche blogs read by your ideal customers to cover you or run your content
Publicity	Stories in traditional media, news outlets, podcasts, and online publications
Unconventional PR	Stunts, contests, and customer appreciation tactics that generate buzz
Search Engine Marketing (SEM)	Paid ads on Google, Bing, and other search engines
Social & Display Ads	Paid ads on Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, Twitter, YouTube
Offline Ads	TV, radio, billboards, direct mail, print advertising
SEO	Ranking organically in search engines for valuable keywords
Content Marketing	Blog posts, guides, videos, and resources that attract and educate
Email Marketing	Sequences and broadcasts to a permission-based subscriber list
Viral Marketing	Mechanisms that get existing users to refer new users automatically
Engineering as Marketing	Free tools, calculators, or microsites that generate leads
Business Development	Strategic partnerships that grow both parties
Sales	Direct outreach and conversion process
Affiliate Programs	Paying others a commission for successful referrals
Existing Platforms	App stores, marketplaces, browser extensions, social platforms
Trade Shows	Industry events where you meet prospects and partners face-to-face
Offline Events	Meetups, conferences, and community gatherings you host or sponsor
Speaking Engagements	Talks at events, conferences, and podcasts
Community Building	Building a tribe around your brand or a shared mission

The Three-Ring Bullseye Process

Outer Ring: What's Possible

For every one of the 19 channels, brainstorm at least one realistic channel strategy. Do not dismiss anything. Many founders ignore channels that feel uncomfortable (cold sales, trade shows, offline ads) even when those channels are exactly where their customers are.

> **AI PROMPT: OUTER RING BRAINSTORM**
> "I am a solo founder building [product/service] for [target customer]. For each of these 19 traction channels, suggest one specific, realistic channel strategy I could test with less than $500 and two weeks: [paste the 19 channels]. Consider where my specific customer hangs out, what they read, and what would genuinely attract them."

Middle Ring: What's Probable

From your outer ring, identify the 3-5 most promising channel strategies. These move to the middle ring — the testing zone. For each, design a small, cheap experiment that answers three questions:

- How much does it cost to acquire a customer through this channel?
- How many customers are realistically available through this channel?
- Are these the right customers for where you are right now?

Each test should cost no more than $500 and take no more than 30 days. The goal is data, not perfection.

Inner Ring: What's Working

When one channel produces promising early results — better cost-per-acquisition, better quality customers, better conversion rates — that becomes your core channel. You focus all traction resources here and go deep.

> **CRITICAL WARNING**
> The biggest Bullseye mistake is keeping secondary channels running because 'they work a little.' A channel that works okay distracts you from finding what works great. When you have a core channel, run everything through it until it saturates.

How AI Accelerates the Bullseye

- Competitor Research: 'Analyze how [competitor] acquires customers based on their public content, backlinks, social presence, and job postings. Which channels appear dominant?'
- Channel Scoring: Feed AI your middle ring ideas with budget and audience data. Ask it to score each by estimated customer acquisition cost and audience size.
- Test Design: 'Design a 30-day, $300 test for the [channel] traction channel for my business [describe business]. Include specific actions, success metrics, and tracking method.'
- Post-Test Analysis: Paste your test data into AI and ask for a clear winner assessment and next-step recommendation.

Your Action Checklist: Strategy 3

1. Use AI to brainstorm at least one idea per channel across all 19.
2. Score each idea against the three Bullseye questions and select your top 3-5 for middle ring testing.
3. Run each middle ring test with a $300-$500 budget and 30-day time limit.
4. Declare a core channel. Shut down the others. Go deep.

S4

Strategy 4

Build Your AI-Powered Lead Capture System

From hunting every day to farming a pipeline

Most small business ads try to sell directly. This is a catastrophic waste of your limited marketing budget.

At any given moment, only 3% of your target market is ready to buy right now. If your ad targets only that 3%, you are ignoring the 37% of people who are interested but not yet ready. A lead capture system changes this completely — it increases your addressable market from 3% to 40%, a 1,233% improvement in marketing effectiveness.

The 3-to-40 Percent Framework

Buyer State	% of Market
Ready to buy NOW	3%
Very open to buying	7%
Interested but not now	30%
Not interested currently	30%
Would not buy regardless	30%

A direct-sale ad captures only the 3%. A lead capture ad that offers value in exchange for contact information captures the 3%, the 7%, and the 30% who are interested but not now — a total of 40%. This is the difference between a leaky bucket and a full pipeline.

The Ethical Bribe: Your Lead Magnet

A lead magnet is a specific, high-value piece of content or tool you offer in exchange for a prospect's email address. You are reading one right now. The best lead magnets:

- Solve one specific, painful problem your ideal customer already has
- Deliver the solution fast — in under 15 minutes of reading or use
- Are titled with the exact result the prospect will get (not vague)
- Demonstrate your expertise without requiring a purchase
- Naturally lead toward your core offer as the logical next step

Lead Magnet Ideas by Content Type

Format	Best Used When...
PDF Guide / Checklist	Your audience needs a structured process or reference they'll return to

Email Mini-Course	The solution requires steps over time — builds relationship naturally
Free Tool / Calculator	A measurable output exists (ROI, score, estimate, audit result)
Video Training / Webinar	Complex topics that benefit from demonstration or presence
Template Pack	You can save them significant time with a pre-built resource
Case Study / Report	You have data or results that prove an insight others don't have

AI PROMPT: LEAD MAGNET GENERATOR

"My target customer is [avatar]. Their top 3 frustrations are [list]. My product/service is [describe]. Generate 10 lead magnet ideas — one for each major content format — that would genuinely help them with their frustration, position me as an expert, and naturally lead toward my offer. Give each a specific title that promises a concrete outcome."

The Minimum Lead Capture System

You need four technical components:

1. A landing page with a single, compelling headline, one offer, and an email opt-in form. No navigation. No distractions.
2. An email marketing platform (ConvertKit, Mailchimp, or ActiveCampaign) to collect and store subscriber data.
3. An automated delivery sequence that sends the lead magnet immediately on signup.
4. A welcome email that sets expectations and begins the relationship.

Use AI to write each component. Prompt for your landing page headline, opt-in button copy, and welcome email in one session. Iterate based on conversion data.

Your Action Checklist: Strategy 4

5. Choose one lead magnet format aligned with your customer's top frustration.
6. Use AI to create the content and write the landing page copy.
7. Set up your email platform and connect your opt-in form.
8. Write and schedule the automated delivery + welcome email.

S5

Strategy 5

Automate Your Lead Nurturing with AI Email Sequences

Become a welcome guest, not a pest

Joe Girard, listed in the Guinness World Records as the world's greatest salesman, sold more retail cars than 95% of all North American dealerships — alone. His secret was not aggressive closing. It was relentless, value-driven follow-up. He sent every single customer a personalized card every month for years.

By the end of his career, two-thirds of his sales were to repeat customers or referrals. The average salesperson follows up once or twice and quits. Joe followed up forever — and built a pipeline so strong that customers had to book appointments to buy from him.

Your email nurture sequence is your automated version of Joe's cards. Set it up once, and it works every day.

The Farmer vs. Hunter Mental Model

Hunters chase every lead. They cold-call, discount, and hustle for every sale. They live and die by this week's pipeline.

Farmers plant seeds. They offer value first, build trust over time, and harvest when the crop is ready. Their pipeline fills itself.

An AI-powered email nurture sequence turns you into a farmer. Leads enter the top, are nurtured over days and weeks, and convert when they're ready — not when you're desperate.

The 7-Touch Nurture Sequence Architecture

Email #	Purpose & Content Type
Email 1 — Immediate	Deliver the lead magnet + warm welcome. Set expectations for what's coming. No pitch.
Email 2 — Day 2	Value email: teach one key insight related to their problem. Position yourself as a guide.
Email 3 — Day 4	Story email: share a relevant case study or your own journey. Build connection.
Email 4 — Day 6	Problem-deepening email: articulate their pain in their language. Show you understand.
Email 5 — Day 8	Solution email: introduce your core offer in the context of solving their problem.
Email 6 — Day 10	Objection-handling email: address the 2-3 most common reasons people hesitate.
Email 7 — Day 12	Call-to-action email: make a specific offer with a clear next step and deadline.

AI PROMPT: NURTURE SEQUENCE WRITER

"Write a 7-email welcome and nurture sequence for new subscribers who downloaded my lead magnet about [topic]. My ideal customer is [avatar]. My core offer is [describe]. Tone: conversational, warm, expert — not corporate. Each email should provide genuine value before the pitch. Include subject lines for each email."

Segmentation: Let AI Personalize at Scale

Not all leads are the same. As your list grows, AI tools can help you segment and personalize without extra manual work:

- Tag subscribers based on which lead magnet they downloaded — each tag maps to a different pain point and nurture track
- Use behavior-based triggers: if someone clicks a link about [topic X], automatically send them more content about [topic X]
- Create a re-engagement sequence for subscribers who go cold after 60 days: 'Have we done something wrong? We'd love to hear from you.'
- Use AI to write personalized subject lines using merge tags: 'The [industry] challenge [first name] probably hasn't solved yet'

The 3-to-1 Value Ratio

For every one email that contains a sales pitch or offer, send three emails that are pure value — a tip, a tool, a story, a resource. This ratio keeps you positioned as a welcome guest rather than a pest. Violate it consistently, and your unsubscribe rate climbs and your open rates collapse.

Your Action Checklist: Strategy 5

1. Write your 7-email nurture sequence using the architecture above.
2. Set up automated delivery in your email platform.
3. Create at least two segments based on lead magnet topic.
4. Schedule a monthly 'evergreen' broadcast that goes to your entire list — a valuable insight, not a pitch.

S6

Strategy 6

Convert Subscribers Into Customers

Sales without the sleaze

By the time a prospect has downloaded your lead magnet, received your nurture sequence, and engaged with your content, something important has happened: they already know you, like you, and trust you. The sale at this point is not a persuasion event. It is the next logical step.

This is the power of the Before-During-After system from the 1-Page Marketing Plan. You do not sell to strangers. You sell to people who have already raised their hand.

The Trust Architecture of a Modern Sale

Most founders think sales resistance comes from price. It rarely does. It comes from fear — the fear of making a wrong decision, being disappointed, wasting money, or being judged. Your job is to systematically dismantle that fear before you make your offer.

Fear to Dismantle	How to Dismantle It
'Will this actually work for me?'	Case studies and testimonials showing people just like them who got results
'What if I'm disappointed?'	An outrageous, specific guarantee that reverses all the risk onto you
'Is this person legitimate?'	Social proof, media mentions, credentials, and consistent track record
'Is this the best option?'	Direct comparison: position your offer as apples vs. competitors' oranges
'Is now the right time?'	Specific, genuine scarcity or urgency with a real reason to act now

The Outrageous Guarantee

A weak guarantee says: 'Satisfaction guaranteed or your money back.' This is meaningless because it is vague.

A strong guarantee names the specific fears your customer has and guarantees against each one with specific language. It transfers all the risk from them to you. If you are confident in your product — which you should be — this costs you almost nothing, and it dramatically increases conversions.

AI PROMPT: GUARANTEE GENERATOR

"My product/service is [describe]. My customer's top 3 fears about buying are [list]. Write 5 versions of an outrageous guarantee that specifically addresses these fears, is worded in plain English, and would make a skeptical prospect think 'There's no risk in trying this.'"

The Consultative Sales Conversation

For higher-ticket offers, AI can help you prepare for and run better sales conversations using the SPIN framework (from Neil Rackham's SPIN Selling, referenced in both source texts):

- Situation Questions: understand their current state without wasting time ('How are you currently handling [problem area]?')
- Problem Questions: surface the pain clearly ('What does that cost you — in time, revenue, or stress?')
- Implication Questions: make the problem feel bigger and more urgent ('If this isn't fixed in 90 days, what happens?')
- Need-Payoff Questions: shift focus to the solution ('If you could solve [problem], what would that mean for your business?')

Pricing as Positioning

Your price is a positioning statement. A low price signals low value. Charge what the outcome is worth, not what the work costs you to deliver. Use the standard/premium structure to give customers choice without overwhelming them:

- Standard: core offer at baseline price
- Premium: 50% higher price, 2x the value — higher margins, better clients
- Ultra-High-Ticket: 10x the standard price for the top 10% who want the very best. 1% of your customers would pay 100x. Most founders never offer this tier and leave enormous money uncaptured.

Your Action Checklist: Strategy 6

1. Build your guarantee — specific, bold, and risk-reversing.
2. Create a pricing menu with standard, premium, and ultra-high-ticket tiers.
3. Write a sales page or email that walks through the five fear-dismantling elements.
4. Use AI to build a set of SPIN questions for your discovery calls.

S7

Strategy 7

Measure, Test, and Optimize with AI

Small improvements compound into extraordinary results

The most powerful sentence in direct response marketing is this: what gets measured, gets managed.

When Mint set a goal of 100,000 users in 6 months, Noah Kagan built a spreadsheet tracking every traction channel by traffic source, conversion rate, and confirmed users. That spreadsheet was the engine of their growth. When data came in, decisions became obvious.

AI doesn't replace this discipline — it makes it faster, more insightful, and available to a solo founder without a data science team.

The Three Numbers That Drive Everything

You only need to improve three numbers to create exponential growth. Here is a real example of what a 10% improvement in each produces:

Metric	Before / After 10% Improvement
Monthly Leads	1,000 leads / 1,100 leads
Conversion Rate	5% / 5.5%
Average Transaction Value	$500 / $550
Total Monthly Revenue	$25,000 / $33,275 (+33%)
Net Profit (after 50% margin, $8k overhead)	$4,500 / $8,638 (+92%)

A 10% improvement in each of three metrics produced a 92% improvement in net profit. This is the leverage point of marketing: small hinges swing enormous doors.

Building Your Marketing Dashboard

Your dashboard does not need to be complex. A simple spreadsheet updated weekly with these metrics is enough:

- New leads per week (by source — which channel is it coming from?)
- Email open rate and click rate (health of your nurture sequence)
- Conversion rate from lead to customer (overall and by segment)
- Customer acquisition cost (total marketing spend / new customers acquired)
- Average transaction value
- Customer lifetime value (average revenue per customer over their full tenure)
- Monthly recurring revenue (if applicable)
- Churn rate (% of customers who stop buying each month)

AI-Powered Testing and Optimization

A/B Testing With AI Support

The Law of Shitty Click-Throughs (coined by Andrew Chen) states that every marketing strategy eventually saturates — what worked brilliantly today becomes ignored tomorrow. The antidote is constant testing.

> **AI PROMPT: A/B TEST DESIGNER**
> "I want to improve the conversion rate on my [email subject line / landing page headline / call-to-action button / ad copy]. My current version is: [paste current version]. Create 5 A/B test variants. For each variant, state what hypothesis it's testing and what result would confirm the hypothesis."

Content Performance Analysis

Paste your last 30 days of email analytics into AI and ask: 'Which subject lines had the highest open rates? What patterns do you see in the high performers versus low performers? What should I test next week?'

Channel Saturation Detection

When a core traction channel begins to plateau — more spend yields less return — it is time to run a new Bullseye process. Ask AI: 'My [channel] CAC has risen from $X to $Y over 90 days. What are 5 potential causes and what should I test first?'

The Referral Multiplier

The final leverage point in your growth system is the referral loop. Every customer you delight has approximately 250 people in their network — friends, colleagues, family — who could become your next customers. That is Joe Girard's Law of 250.

Active referral orchestration means:

- Asking for referrals specifically (not generally — name the type of person you want referred)
- Building a gift card or incentive that makes giving a referral feel like giving a gift, not promoting a business
- Identifying complementary businesses that serve your customers before or after you, and building joint venture arrangements
- Using AI to write personalized referral request emails for each customer segment: 'If you know someone who is [specific situation], I have something that would help them'

Your Action Checklist: Strategy 7

1. Build your marketing dashboard — even a simple spreadsheet is enough to start.
2. Identify your single weakest metric and run 3 A/B tests to improve it this month.
3. Set up a referral system with a specific ask, a specific incentive, and a specific type of referral requested.
4. Schedule a quarterly Bullseye review: test new channels before your current channel saturates.

Putting It All Together: Your 90-Day Launch Plan

You now have seven strategies. The question is: where do you start, and in what order?

Here is a sequenced 90-day implementation plan designed for a solo founder who is building their marketing system for the first time:

Timeline	Focus & Actions
Week 1-2: FOUNDATION	Complete Strategy 1 (Avatar) and Strategy 2 (Message). These unlock everything else. Without clarity on who you're talking to and what you're saying, all tactics fail.
Week 3-4: CAPTURE	Build your lead magnet and landing page (Strategy 4). Set up your email platform. Publish and drive initial traffic through one free channel.
Week 5-8: NURTURE	Write and schedule your 7-email nurture sequence (Strategy 5). Begin the Bullseye process (Strategy 3) — brainstorm all 19 channels with AI and run your first 2 middle-ring tests.
Week 9-10: CONVERT	Launch your sales offer with your guarantee (Strategy 6). Activate your nurture sequence subscribers with a conversion email.
Week 11-12: MEASURE	Set up your marketing dashboard (Strategy 7). Run your first A/B tests. Review Bullseye test results and declare a core channel.
Month 4+: OPTIMIZE	Deepen your core channel. Begin referral orchestration. Run monthly Bullseye reviews. Add one new channel per quarter.

THE ONE RULE TO REMEMBER

Spend 50% of your time on product, 50% on traction. Not 80/20. Not 90/10. Fifty-fifty. A great product that no one knows about is not a business. Marketing is not a nice-to-have — it is half the job.

The Mindset Shift That Changes Everything

Allan Dib writes: 'You need to stop being a business owner who does some marketing, and become a marketer who owns a business.'

This is not semantic. It changes your priorities, your daily schedule, your hiring decisions, and your self-identity. The best product rarely wins. The best-marketed product wins far more often.

You now have the system. The AI tools have never been more accessible or more powerful. The only variable left is execution.

A Final Note on AI and Marketing

AI is not a replacement for strategic thinking. It is a force multiplier for the thinking you have already done. An AI prompt given without a clear customer avatar, without a compelling message, and without a defined goal will produce generic output.

Feed AI with the deep customer knowledge you built in Strategy 1, the specific message architecture from Strategy 2, and the channel data from Strategy 3 — and it becomes extraordinarily powerful. The frameworks in this guide are your inputs. AI is your engine.

What Comes Next

This e-book is your foundation. Share it with anyone you know who is building something and struggling to get it in front of the right people.

If you are ready to go deeper on any of these strategies — with templates, workflows, and live coaching — reply to any email in this newsletter series with the word READY and tell me which of the 7 strategies you want to tackle first.

I read every reply.

The best time to plant a tree was yesterday. *The second best time is today.*

Quick Reference: AI Prompts by Strategy

Copy and paste these into ChatGPT, Claude, or your AI tool of choice. Replace the [brackets] with your specific context.

Strategy 1: Target Market

AVATAR BUILDER

"I am building [product/service] for [target segment]. Create a detailed customer avatar including: demographics, job situation, top 3 daily frustrations, exact words they use to describe their pain, what they've already tried and why it failed, and what success looks like for them."

PAIN LANGUAGE EXTRACTOR

"Here are 20 reviews/posts from my target customers: [paste]. Extract the most emotionally charged phrases they use to describe their frustration. Group by theme and identify the top 3 pain patterns."

Strategy 2: Message & Offer

USP GENERATOR

"My business does [describe]. My top 3 competitors are [names]. Generate 5 USP statements that are specific, credible, outcome-focused, and create an apples-to-oranges comparison with competitors."

HEADLINE GENERATOR

"Write 20 marketing headline variations for [offer]. Use formats including: fear of loss, desire for gain, specific result promise, and curiosity gap. Each headline should speak directly to [avatar]."

Strategy 3: Bullseye Channel Testing

CHANNEL BRAINSTORM

"For each of the 19 traction channels [list them], suggest one specific, testable channel strategy for a solo founder selling [product] to [customer], with a test budget of $300-$500 and 30 days."

Strategy 4: Lead Capture

LEAD MAGNET IDEAS

"My target customer is [avatar] who struggles with [problem]. My offer is [describe]. Generate 10 lead magnet ideas across different formats that would genuinely help them, position me as an expert, and lead naturally to my offer."

Strategy 5: Email Nurture

NURTURE SEQUENCE WRITER

"Write a 7-email welcome and nurture sequence for new subscribers who downloaded my lead magnet about [topic]. Customer: [avatar]. Core offer: [describe]. Tone: conversational, warm, expert. Include subject lines."

Strategy 6: Sales Conversion

GUARANTEE GENERATOR

"My product/service is [describe]. My customer's top 3 fears about buying are [list]. Write 5 versions of an outrageous, specific guarantee that addresses these fears in plain English and makes a skeptical prospect say 'There's no risk in trying this.'"

Strategy 7: Measurement & Optimization

A/B TEST DESIGNER

"I want to improve conversion on my [headline / subject line / CTA]. Current version: [paste]. Create 5 A/B test variants. For each, state the hypothesis being tested and the expected impact."

Recommended Reading

This playbook draws directly from these two foundational texts. If you want to go deeper, start here:

Book	Why It Matters for Solo Founders
Traction by Gabriel Weinberg & Justin Mares	The definitive guide to finding your best customer acquisition channel. Contains the Bullseye Framework and detailed profiles of all 19 traction channels. Read this to escape channel bias.
The 1-Page Marketing Plan by Allan Dib	The most practical small business marketing system available. The Before-During-After framework will restructure how you think about the entire customer journey.
SPIN Selling by Neil Rackham	The gold standard for consultative sales conversations. If you have any direct sales element to your business, this is essential reading.
Influence by Robert Cialdini	The psychology of why people say yes. Understanding contrast, social proof, and reciprocity will make every piece of copy you write more effective.

The Solo Founder's AI Marketing Playbook

7 Strategies for Predictable Growth

Thank you for reading.